

World Triathlon Rule Interpretation - Hydration Systems & Fairing

After extensive meetings with Deutsche Triathlon Union, the World Triathlon Technical Committee, and the bicycle manufacturers' industry, World Triathlon has developed a rule interpretation document on the World Triathlon Fairing rules. The new rules will be in place from April 15.

Key changes and clarifications are:

1. Handlebars

- Only handlebars and clip-on bars that do not extend beyond the leading edge of the front wheel will be permitted. Extension grips and shifters are included.
- When measured from the lowest edge of the arm support (if none exists, the lowest edge of the athlete's elbow in the rider's intended aero position), all attached objects on the handlebars or the clip-ons (bottles, holders, containers, etc.) must be within an area with the following dimensions:
 - a maximum of 250 mm in the direction of the saddle and
 - a maximum of 200 mm in height and
 - no further than the foremost point of the handlebars or clip-ons, and
 - a maximum of 5 mm from the highest point of the front wheel.
- No part of the body may rest on the attached objects, bottles, holders, containers, etc.
- The following components are excluded from this regulation:
 - Bicycle Computer
 - Bicycle Computer Mount
 - Extension Grips*
 - Extension Shifters.
- The Extension Grip includes the structural part of the handlebar enclosed by the athlete's hand in the intended aero position."
- The arms may not be covered from above by any components.

2. Hydration Systems

- **Mounted to Steering Axis:** Hydration volume (e.g., bottles or hydration systems) mounted to components that rotate around the steering axis (e.g., aerobar extensions, base bar) may have a combined maximum capacity of 2 litres;
- **Rear Mounted:** Rear-mounted hydration systems (excluding those mounted to the inside of the frame triangle bicycle) are limited in size, capacity, dimension, and location as set forth below:
 - cannot contain more than two water bottles;

- must not exceed 1L capacity per bottle.
- **Mounted in the bicycle frame:** Bottles attached to the inside of the bicycle frame or inside the bicycle frame itself (internal bladder) are excluded from the maximum volume capacity limits.

3. Placement Of Rear Mounted Equipment

- All attached holders, containers, bottle holders, etc., must fit completely into an imaginary frame no larger than 30x30cm. Bottles may protrude beyond this area.
- A maximum of 2 bottles with a maximum capacity of one litre each are permitted.

4. Exception For Rear Mounted Equipment

- Rear mounted Hydration systems integrated into the frame:
 - may be larger than 30 x 30 cm,
 - may not contain more than 2 litres in total,
 - must not protrude beyond the vertical line through the rear axle.
 - On bicycles with rear mounted hydration systems that are integrated into the frame, no additional hydration may be added to the rear of the frame.
- Rear mounted Race Ranger device
- Rear mounted storage boxes that are able to contain tubes, CO2, tire levers, and other tools necessary for basic maintenance.

5. Top tube:

- Any items attached to the top tube may:
 - be attached anywhere along the length of the top tube, and may use the entire length of the tube.
 - be a maximum of 10 cm high, measured from the top edge of the top tube,
 - not be wider than the top tube itself, and
 - may not cover the steering axis. If a device is attached to the top tube and extended to the handlebar, a joint is required above the steering axis.
 - No part of the body may rest on any part of the frame construction or attachments.
- **In general:**
 - The rule for the top tube applies from the base of the movable part of the steering head to the seat post. The rule for the handlebar and all handlebar attachments applies from the moving part of the steering head in the direction of travel.

6. Prohibited Items:

- Bottles/hydration or any other objects (excluding nutrition) attached to or inserted in an athlete's race suit in a manner deemed to provide an aerodynamic advantage;
- Any inserts in an athlete's calf sleeves and arm sleeves.

These updates aim to provide clearer guidelines on fairing and equipment regulations for World Triathlon events. Please refer to the official Rules for complete details

